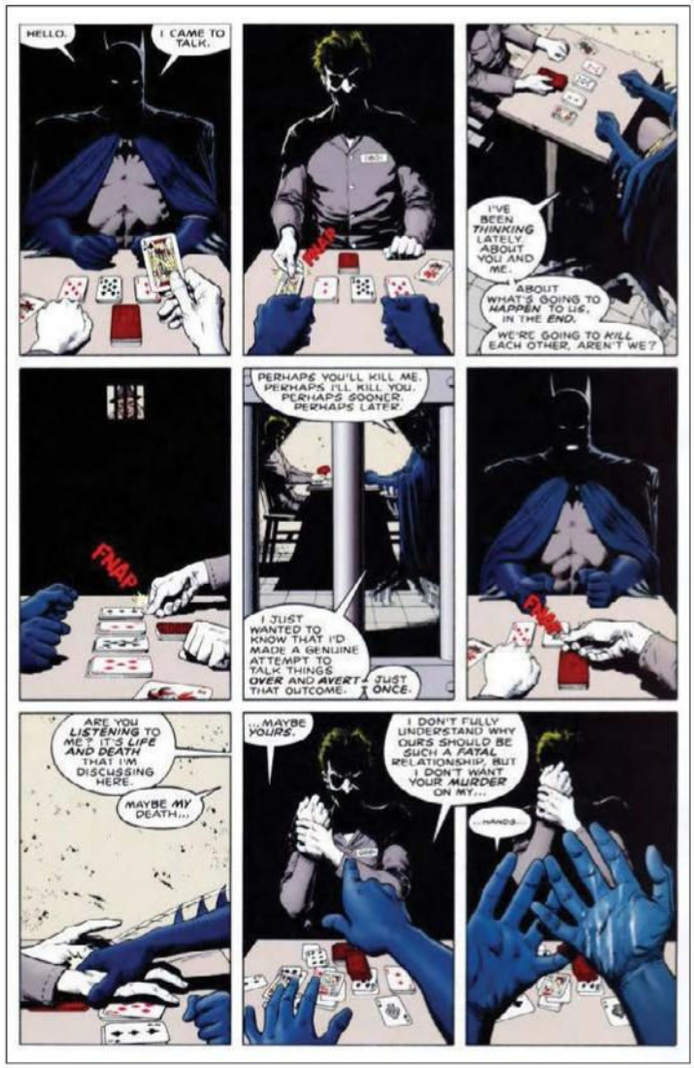
BATMAN: THE KILLING JOKE

Details **Originally published** Batman: The Killing Joke (1988) **Publisher** DC **Writer** Alan Moore
Artist Brian Bolland **Collected in** Batman: The Killing Joke (Special hardcover edition) 2008
Available digitally Comixology, iBookstore

Widely regarded as the greatest Joker story ever told, *Batman: The Killing Joke* is a standalone story that defined Alan Moore as a staple DC writer, and affected the wider *Batman* canon directly for 15 years after its release. Half Joker origin, half examination of the darker side of human nature, *The Killing Joke* focuses on the Joker's obsession with the idea that anyone can go mad – all it takes is one bad day. To this end, he kidnaps Commissioner Gordon as his experimental subject.

Moore's writing manages to duck in and out of modern day and flashback without pause, almost justifying Joker's torture of Gordon while showing that there *are* weaknesses in the Joker's character – he's just so insane that he's forgotten they're there. Brian Bolland's art never reuses a pose or steps into comic cliché, but rather remains expressive and moody throughout the book, the sketchy linework perfectly complimenting the narrative's obsession with the blurry line between genius and insanity.







"BOLLAND'S ART NEVER REUSES A POSE OR STEPS INTO COMIC CLICHÉ"